EXPERIMENT 10

Vehicle Service Request Form in Zoho Creator

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Aim

To design and build the Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management application in Zoho Creator, with the form **Service_Request_Form** that demonstrates the correct use of all thirteen Basic Fields of the Form Builder, configures field-level validations, and records service requests in the report **Service_Request_Report**.

Introduction

An automobile service center that accepts service requests only through phone calls faces double-booked service bays, no advance record of the reported problem, and no way for technicians to prepare parts or estimates before the vehicle arrives. Walk-in customers also wait for long hours because there is no prior scheduling system.

Zoho Creator is a low-code platform in which a single online form can replace this process. The vehicle owner submits identity, contact, vehicle, issue and scheduling details through one form, and every submission is stored as a record that the front office can filter, schedule and assign to a technician before the vehicle arrives. Choosing the correct Basic Field for each piece of data keeps the captured information clean, validated and easy to report on.

Application Used

The practical was performed in Zoho Creator using the application **Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management** and its form **Service_Request_Form**. The primary users are vehicle owners, who submit requests, and the service center front office and technicians, who review them in the report **Service_Request_Report**. The report lists all submitted service requests and lets the service center filter, schedule and assign technicians for incoming vehicles. Deluge scripting was used for the form workflow that sends an acknowledgement email when a request is submitted.

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Basic Fields Concept

Basic Fields are the standard input types in the Zoho Creator Form Builder palette. Each field stores a particular kind of data and brings its own built-in behaviour, such as a date picker, an email format check or a country-code phone format. The form uses all thirteen Basic Fields, and each one is mapped to a specific role in the service request, as shown below.

Basic Field	Form Field Name	Purpose	Sample Value
Name	Owner_Name	Captures the full name of the vehicle owner using First/Last name sub-fields	Ramesh Kannan
Email	Email_Address	Captures a validated email address for the service estimate and status updates	ramesh.kannan@example.com
Address	Pickup_Address	Captures the owner's address for a pickup/drop service, if requested	9, Cross Street, Salem, TN, 636001
Phone	Contact_Number	Captures a validated mobile number for the service center to call with updates	+91 93450 66778
Single Line	Vehicle_Registration_Number	Captures a short free-text entry for the vehicle's registration / number plate	TN 34 AB 5678
Multi Line	Issue_Description	Captures a free-text description of the problem the vehicle is experiencing	Unusual grinding noise from the front brakes and reduced mileage over the last week.
Number	Odometer_Reading	Captures a numeric value, with validation, for the current odometer reading in kilometers	45230
Date	Preferred_Service_Date	Captures the preferred date to bring in the vehicle, using a date picker	30-Jul-2026
Time	Preferred_Dropoff_Time	Captures the preferred time slot to drop off the vehicle at the service bay	9:00 AM
Drop Down	Vehicle_Type	Presents a single-select list of vehicle categories serviced by the center	Hatchback
Radio	Service_Type	Captures a single mandatory selection among mutually exclusive service categories	Breakdown Repair
Multi Select	Additional_Services_Requested	Allows selection of one or more add-on services along with the main repair	Car Wash, Interior Cleaning, Tyre Rotation
Checkbox	Authorize_Estimate_And_Repair	Captures the owner's authorization for the center to prepare an estimate and proceed with the work	Checked (Agreed)

Table 1: Mapping of the Basic Fields to the Service_Request_Form

Procedure

1. Open Zoho Creator, click **Create Application** and create a new application named **Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management**.

2. Create a new form named **Service_Request_Form** and open it in the Form Builder.

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3. From the Basic Fields palette, drag the thirteen fields onto the canvas, arrange them into the four sections A to D (Figure 1), and set the field names given in Table 1.

4. Add the choices for the selection fields: the vehicle categories for **Vehicle_Type** (Drop Down); Routine Service, Breakdown Repair and Accident Repair for **Service_Type** (Radio); and the add-on services such as Car Wash, Interior Cleaning and Tyre Rotation for **Additional_Services_Requested** (Multi Select).

5. Configure the validation rules listed in the Validation Rules section.

6. Create the form workflow **Send acknowledgement email**, triggered on Created → Successful form submission, and add the Deluge script given in the Deluge Code section.

7. Create the report **Service_Request_Report** and enable filters on Service Type and Preferred Service Date.

8. Open the live preview of the form, submit at least three sample requests, and verify that the records appear in the report.

Form Layout

The form is divided into four customer-friendly sections so that the owner can complete it in a logical order. Figure 1 is a conceptual diagram of the layout.

Section-wise Layout of Service_Request_Form

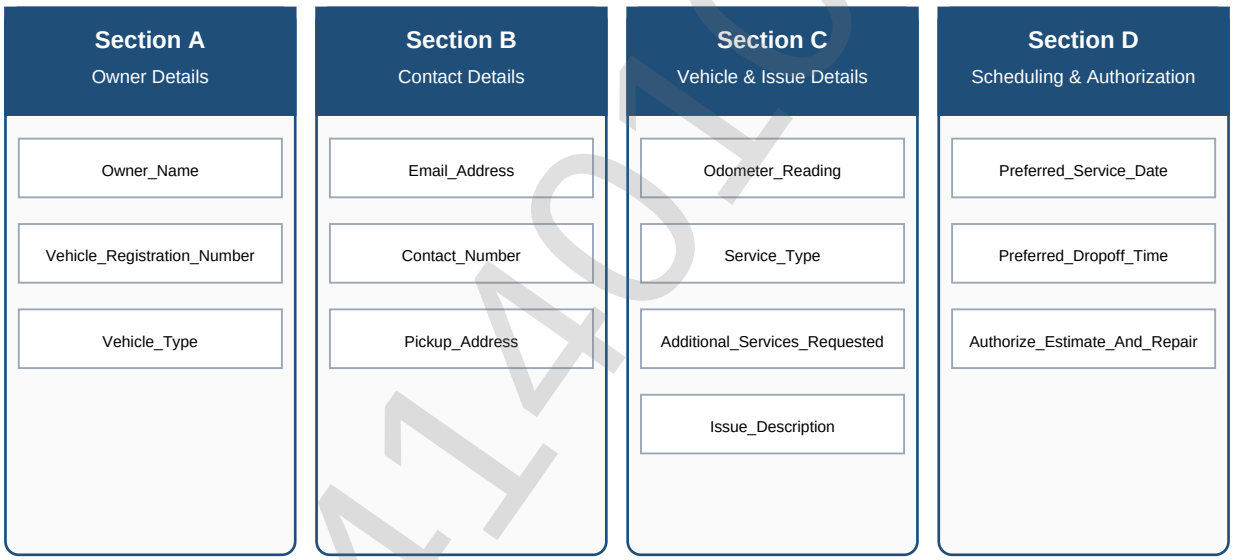


Figure 1: Form Layout of the Service Request Form (Conceptual Diagram, Not a Screenshot)

Section	Fields Included
A – Owner Details	Owner Name (First Name, Last Name), Vehicle Registration Number (Single Line), Vehicle Type (Drop Down)
B – Contact Details	Email Address (Email), Contact Number (Phone), Pickup Address (Address)
C – Vehicle & Issue Details	Odometer Reading (Number), Service Type (Radio: Routine Service / Breakdown Repair / Accident Repair), Additional Services Requested (Multi Select), Issue Description (Multi Line)
D – Scheduling & Authorization	Preferred Service Date (Date), Preferred Drop-off Time (Time), “I authorize the service center to prepare an estimate and proceed” (Checkbox)

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Validation Rules

The following field-level validations were configured so that only complete and correctly formatted requests are accepted.

Field	Validation Configured
Owner_Name, Contact_Number, Vehicle_Registration_Number, Vehicle_Type, Service_Type, Authorize_Estimate_And_Repair	Marked as mandatory fields
Email_Address	Built-in email format validation enabled
Contact_Number	Country code format enabled for Indian numbers
Odometer_Reading	Restricted to positive values only
Preferred_Service_Date	Past dates are not allowed
Authorize_Estimate_And_Repair	The form cannot be submitted unless the checkbox is checked

Table 2: Validation Rules of the Service_Request_Form

Workflow Summary

Step 1: The owner opens the public form link shared through the service center's website or SMS.

Step 2: The owner fills in the personal, vehicle, issue and scheduling details across the four sections.

Step 3: On clicking Submit, Zoho Creator validates all mandatory fields and formats.

Step 4: A new record is created in the Service_Request_Report.

Step 5: An automated acknowledgement email is sent to the owner using the Email field value.

Step 6: The service center reviews the report, filters by Service Type and Preferred Service Date, and assigns a technician and service bay ahead of the vehicle's arrival.

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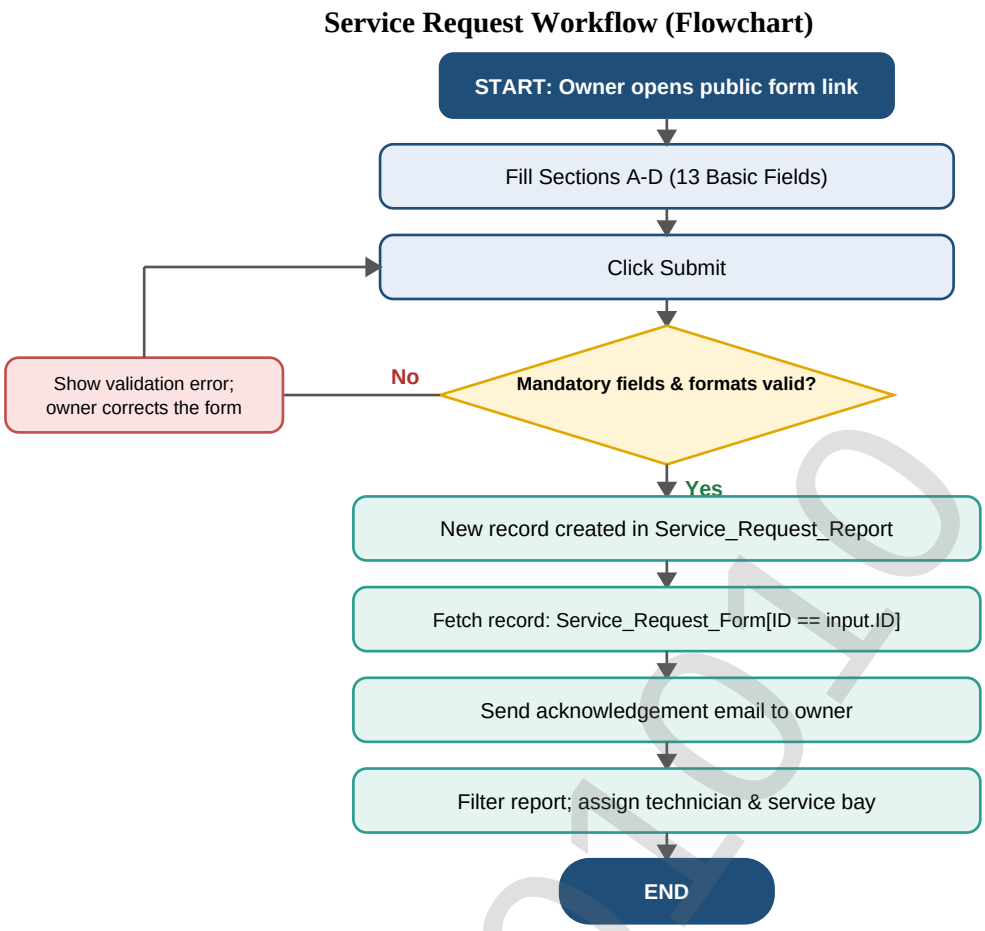


Figure 2: Vehicle Service Request Workflow (Conceptual Diagram)

Deluge Code

The Deluge script of the form workflow **Send acknowledgement email** (Created → Successful form submission) is as follows:

```
serviceRequest = Service_Request_Form[ID == input.ID];

if(serviceRequest.Email_Address.isBlank())
{
    info "Email address is missing for this service request";
}
else
{
    sendmail
    [
        from :zoho.adminuserid
        to :serviceRequest.Email_Address
        subject :"Your Vehicle Service Request is Received"
        message :"<p>Dear " + serviceRequest.Owner_Name.first_name + ",</p>"
            + "<p>Your service request for vehicle "
            + serviceRequest.Vehicle_Registration_Number
            + " has been received. Preferred date: "
            + serviceRequest.Preferred_Service_Date + ".</p>"
            + "<p>Our front office will confirm the slot and assign a "
            + "technician shortly.</p><p>Thank you for choosing us.</p>"
    ]
}
```

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The first statement fetches only the submitted record by its ID, using the criteria **ID == input.ID**, instead of retrieving every service request. If the Email_Address field of that record is blank, an informational message is displayed. Otherwise, an acknowledgement email with the subject “Your Vehicle Service Request is Received” is sent to the owner's email address.

Report View

Every submitted request is stored as a record in **Service_Request_Report**. The service center filters this report by Service Type and Preferred Service Date to schedule requests and to assign technicians and service bays. Three sample submitted records are shown below. The first uses the sample values of Table 1; the other two are sample data entered for demonstration.

Service_Request_Report: Sample Submitted Records

Owner Name	Vehicle Reg. No.	Vehicle Type	Service Type	Odometer (km)	Preferred Date	Drop-off
Ramesh Kannan	TN 34 AB 5678	Hatchback	Breakdown Repair	45230	30-Jul-2026	9:00 AM
Priya Sharma	TN 09 CD 1234	Sedan	Routine Service	21800	01-Aug-2026	10:30 AM
Arun Prakash	TN 11 EF 9087	SUV	Accident Repair	68450	03-Aug-2026	11:00 AM

Figure 3: Report View with Sample Records (Illustrative Representation, Not a Screenshot)

Learning Outcomes

- Understood the purpose and correct use case of each Basic Field in Zoho Creator.
- Learned to structure a service-request form into logical, customer-friendly sections.
- Practised configuring field-level validations: mandatory, format and range checks.
- Understood how form field values feed into report views and service-scheduling workflows.

Conclusion

The Vehicle Service & Repair Request Management application was built in Zoho Creator with the form **Service_Request_Form**, which uses all thirteen Basic Fields: Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, Drop Down, Radio, Multi Select and Checkbox. Each field was chosen to match the kind of data it captures, and the mandatory, format, range and date validations ensure that only complete and correct requests are submitted.

Submitted requests are stored in **Service_Request_Report**, where the service center can filter by service type and preferred date and assign technicians and service bays before the vehicle arrives. An automated acknowledgement email keeps the owner informed. Together, these features replace phone-based booking with a scheduled, pre-recorded process that avoids double-booked bays and long waiting times.

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